

VISUAL ARTS

सत्यं च वैणिकं चैव नागरं मिश्रमेव च ।
चित्रं चतुर्विधं प्रोक्तं तस्य वक्ष्यामि लक्षणम् ॥ १ ॥

– विष्णुधर्मोत्तरपुराण, 41.1

Satyaṁ cha vaiṇikaṁ chaiva nāgaraṁ miśhrameva cha |
Chitraṁ chatur-vidhaṁ proktaṁ tasya vakṣhyāmi lakṣhaṇam || 1 ||

– Viṣṇu-dharmottara Purāṇa, 41.1

Meaning: According to Chapter 41, Volume 1 of the ‘Chitra-sūtra’ in the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara Purāṇa*, there are four types of paintings:

Satya (Realistic), *Vaiṇika* (Classical/ Lyrical), *Nāgara* (Urban/ Refined), and *Miśhra* (Mixed). I shall now describe their characteristics.



Image depicting life in a city

Note to the Teacher

The Visual Arts chapters lay emphasis on daily practice, guiding students in the application of fundamentals as they discover the elements and principles of art and design in every aspect of their everyday life and surroundings. They will also expand their knowledge of materials, mediums and techniques, and learn to create their own compositions in a systematic and iterative way. You may modify the activities to suit your local context and the specific needs of your students. To ensure the best learning experience for every student, here are some points that need to be kept in mind.

The Visual Arts classroom needs:

- ❖ adequate space for students to sit and work comfortably;
- ❖ sufficient lighting and ventilation;
- ❖ access to and proper storage of art materials, tools, basic stationery, and audio-visual facilities; and
- ❖ space for showcasing and exhibiting artwork periodically.

The Visual Arts pedagogy would need to:

- ❖ use storytelling and everyday examples when introducing concepts and processes;
- ❖ encourage students to freely express their original ideas, imagination, emotions, and curiosities in their artwork;
- ❖ encourage keen observations of everyday life and discourage copying images from other pictures and photographs;
- ❖ allow students to explore, investigate, experiment, collaborate, and have discussions (or engage in dialogue) in the classroom;
- ❖ include outdoor activities periodically, for example, drawing plants, animals, people, and objects from their surroundings in different seasons;
- ❖ organise field trips; visits to museums, heritage monuments, and *melas* to enable students to observe the life and culture around them;
- ❖ invite local artists and craftspeople to conduct interactive sessions and workshops that offer students hands-on experiences;
- ❖ emphasise routines of cleaning up after work (such as putting back materials they use and maintaining art materials with care); and
- ❖ encourage students to participate in deciding the selection of artwork for classroom display or exhibitions.

Visual Arts Assessment should be based on the following Competencies for the Secondary Stage

C 1.1 Evaluate own interest in Visual Art forms by considering its scope of practice and application (Fine Arts, crafts, applied art/design, Art research and management)

C 1.2 Initiate discussions and take steps to find more information and resources to pursue their interest in the Visual Arts

C 2.1 Apply the elements and principles of Visual Arts into their artwork and incorporate these into their routine life

C 2.2 Analyse the development of visual expression across a series of works

C 3.1 Extend explorations and refine techniques in the Visual Arts through regular practice

C 3.2 Incorporate ideas and elements from various genres of Indian Visual Arts (traditional, popular, contemporary) into their artwork

C 4.1 Analyse commonalities and differences among diverse forms of Visual Arts, cultures, and aesthetic sensibilities in India and the rest of the world

C 4.2 Evaluate artwork based on creative expression, artistry, and social context

Learning Outcomes That Can Be Assessed Across All Chapters		
Curricular Goals	Competencies	Learning Outcomes
1	C-1.1	Journal their interests, observations, and experiences through visuals and notes
2	C-2.1	Practise basic Visual Arts processes regularly (for example, the student spends 10–15 minutes every day to create a drawing from observation)
3	C-3.1	Demonstrate familiarity with the use and maintenance of materials and tools used in Visual Arts
1	C-1.1, C-1.2	Express their interests in various branches of Visual Arts and make inquiries about visual artists

Chapter 14: Exploring the Fundamentals of Visual Arts		
Curricular Goals	Competencies	Learning Outcomes
1	C-1.1	Journal their interests, observations, and experiences through visuals and notes
2	C-2.1	Practise basic Visual Arts processes regularly (for example, the student spends 10–15 minutes every day to create a drawing from observation)

Chapter 15: Mediums and Techniques in Visual Art		
Curricular Goals	Competencies	Learning Outcomes
3	C-3.1	Demonstrate familiarity with the use and maintenance of materials and tools used in Visual Arts
3	C-3.1	Practise colour exercises using a variety of materials and mediums
3	C-3.1	Apply perspective techniques to show spatial depth in their artwork
3	C-3.2	Create a three-dimensional artwork using a hand-crafting technique from any part of India (for example, relief in clay, bamboo crafts, fabric toys, paper mache, jute/fibre crafts, etc).

Chapter 16: Visual Composition		
Curricular Goals	Competencies	Learning Outcomes
3	C-3.1	Create multiple iterations in the process of developing their ideas and making artworks
2	C-2.2	Compare multiple iterations of one's own artwork to explain how the arrangement of visual elements convey different meanings and emotions

Chapter 17: Branches of Visual Arts		
Curricular Goals	Competencies	Learning Outcomes
1	C-1.1, C-1.2	Express their interests in various branches of Visual Arts and make inquiries about visual artists

14 Exploring the Fundamentals of Visual Arts



Art is a reflection of society. It shows how people have experienced life at different stages through the ages, and how they have responded to their surroundings. The Visual Arts is a very powerful means of expression, especially when you cannot find words to express something.

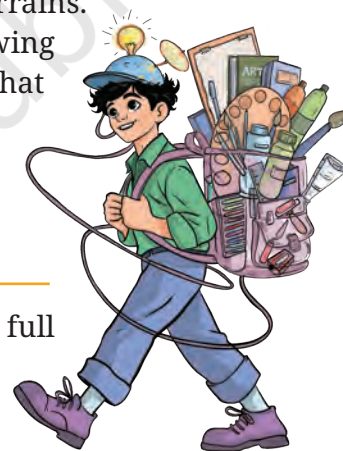
Making visual artwork will help you discover your hidden strengths and unique qualities. You will be able to spend long periods of time imagining, reflecting, pondering, researching, and experimenting in creative ways.

Through the Visual Arts, you will explore unknown terrains. Since explorations need preparation, read the following section carefully and discuss every point in class so that you can help one another while facing challenges during your discoveries.



Essentials for a Visual Artist

Visualise a special bag having multiple compartments full of art materials. Begin by gathering these essentials in your bag.



S.No.	Stationery	Art Materials
1.	Journal	▪ The most important item in your bag. ▪ It should be compact (with at least 50 empty pages). ▪ It can be ruled, unruled, graphed, or made of recycled paper, or a mix of all.
2.	Pencil	A pencil and sharpener
3.	Glue	A small glue stick or bottle of gum/ glue

Desirable Traits of a Visual Artist		
1.	Curiosity	To observe and know the world
2.	Wonder	At the beauty of life and your surroundings
3.	Desire	To express yourself
4.	Courage	To explore new ideas
5.	Motivation	To experiment
6.	Commitment	To practice
7.	Perseverance	To resolve challenges
8.	Satisfaction	With your efforts
9.	Aspiration	To improve
10.	Respect	For your journey and that of others
11.	Gratitude	For what you have and the environment that has helped in your achievements



Art Journal

A journal is a documentation or record of everyday experiences seen in different forms, such as handwritten diaries, sketchbooks, blogs, vlogs, photographs, reels, etc. Journals can contain text, drawings, pictures, moving images, sounds, and tactile materials.

Journalling is a healthy practice that helps us reflect on the way we think, emote, and relate to the world. For a visual artist or student, a journal is an important personal space for practice and growth.

You will use your journal through all activities. At the end of the term, you can compile your journals, sketches, drawings, and completed artwork to present them as your **Visual Art portfolio**.

Importance of a journal

- Captures a live moment or experience;
- Promotes keen observation;
- Records ideas and emotions in their nascent form, along with the date and time; and
- Helps in reflecting one's own growth over longer periods of time.

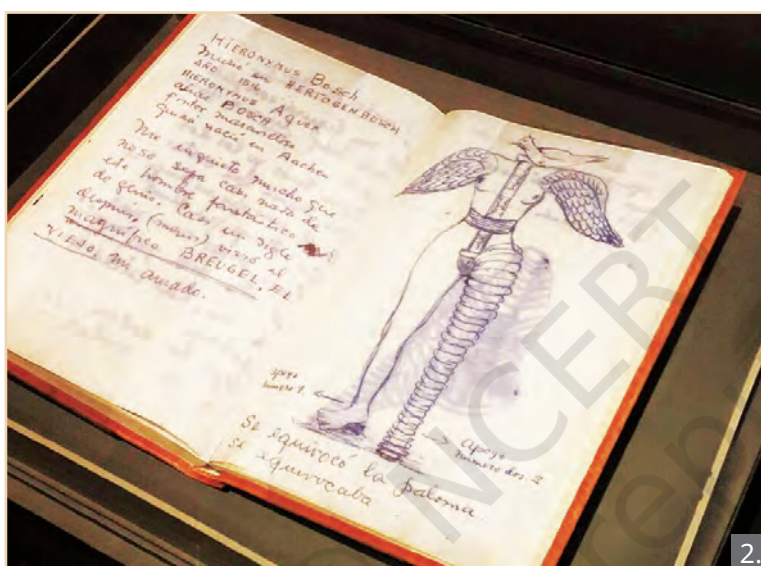


Inspiring examples of visual journalling from history

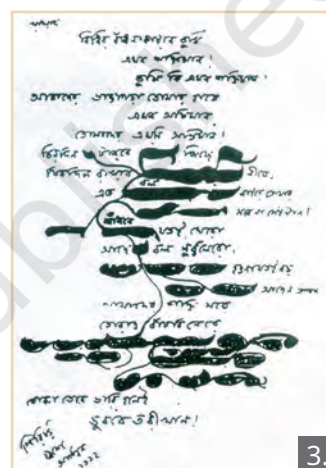
Visual artworks have been instrumental in helping historians and researchers understand events, people, and natural phenomena from the past. Although we may not know much about the languages of prehistoric people, their drawings and paintings on cave walls have provided many insights into their lives. Similarly, your journal would provide insights into how you think and feel.



1.



2.



3.



4.



5.

Fig. 14.1. (1) Page from a notebook of Leonardo Da Vinci; (2) Diary of Frida Kahlo; (3) Poem with doodles by Rabindranath Tagore; (4) Mughal artist Ustad Mansur, who documented various birds; (5) Illustration by Nandalal Bose of the poem 'Rikto' by Rabindranath Tagore

Just as scientists maintain log books and sportspersons record their performance timings, artists use journals to keep a record of their work and plan it. Find out more through this activity.

Activity 14.1

Explore artists' journals in groups

Step 1: Make five groups.

Step 2: Use books or digital resources to search for artists' journals. You could also choose from the examples given in Fig. 14.1.

- ◆ Leonardo Da Vinci's notebooks
- ◆ Frida Kahlo's diary
- ◆ Rabindranath Tagore's doodles
- ◆ Painting of birds and animals by Ustad Mansur
- ◆ Nandalal Bose's illustration

Step 3: Share your findings about how visual artists recorded various experiences and ideas in their journals.



Note to the teacher: Prepare in advance by compiling pictures of artists' journals from the internet or from books to provide students sufficient examples for this activity.



Different Ways of Journalling



Drawing or sketching: It is used by artists, architects, and designers to visualise their ideas; make small studies; and work out solutions to problems.

Collage: It is used by artists who are interested in printed matter or tactile surfaces. They collect pictures from newspapers or magazines, textile scraps, samples of woven fibres, etc., and paste these in their journal.



Photography: Smartphone cameras have made photography accessible to many people. People create digital photo journals based on different themes that interest them.

Videography: Short videos lasting a few seconds to a minute are also a form of journalling. This is also a common digital medium these days.



Important reminders when journalling

1. Focus on being authentic when you record your observations, thoughts, and experiences. Avoid attempting to impress others.
2. Write the date, time, and place in each entry. For example, you could draw a quick sketch of an object or a person you have observed at home. Next to the drawing, write the date, place, and time like this: DD/MM/YYYY, 00:00 a.m./p.m., sitting at home with my family.
3. Include notes and thoughts with your drawings and pictures in the journal. For example, if you have pasted an interesting clothing pattern cut-out from a magazine, write about the elements that interest you and why.
4. Set weekly goals and track your progress. You could decide to make one entry a day or spend more time on alternate days. At the end of each week, spend 10 minutes looking at your journal, check that you have written — the date, time, and other details — and assess your progress.
5. Consolidate your journals at the end of each term. You may have made entries in more than one book.



Fig. 14.2. Journalling a scene at home

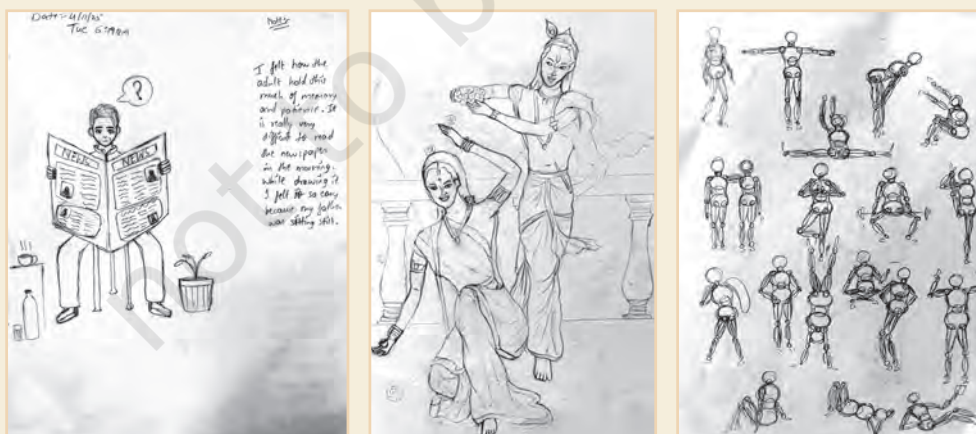


Fig. 14.3. Pages from students' journals

Activity 14.2

Apply the elements of art

The elements of art are basic components that are used to create a visual artwork.

- ◆ Dedicate a page in your journal for each of the seven elements of art.
- ◆ Create the element in many varieties using different materials.
- ◆ Create designs and patterns, and fill the entire page.

Day	Element	Mediums and Techniques	Suggestions
1.	Point	Pencils, pens, sketch pens, markers	Make dots of varying sizes.
2.	Line	Pencils, pens, colour pencils, crayons, pastels, charcoal, chalk	Draw curvy, wavy, zigzag, dotted, dashed, and other types of lines in varying thickness.
3.	Shape and Form	Pencils, pens, markers, crayons, paints	Doodle and create different shapes. Add light and shade to create a three-dimensional form.
4.	Texture	Collage, frottage	Collect and paste textured materials. Create rubbings of textured surfaces and objects.
5.	Colour	Crayons, colour pencils, water colours, poster colours	Play with blotches of colour in different mediums.
6.	Value	Crayons, colour pencils, water colours, poster colours	Create colour tints, tones, and shades to show value.
7.	Space	Any of the above mediums	Draw lines to demarcate the space on the page in interesting ways. Play with positive and negative space.



Sketching

It is an exercise for **spontaneous observation and drawing**, which is used across many disciplines. It is similar to doing a warm-up and stretches practised by sportspersons. It is therefore very important to practise sketching regularly while observing your surroundings.

Avoid copying from other pictures.

Remember, the first steps are always messy. When you start sketching initially, it is natural to experience dissatisfaction and disappointment in your work. This is when your dispositions help you to pick up courage, commitment, and perseverance. When you observe more carefully and sketch repeatedly, you will see your sketches improve in a few weeks.



Fig. 14.4. A special child sketching. Artists cross all barriers when it comes to their passion

Sketching tips

1. Sketches **need not be perfect** or contain too many details.
2. **Position yourself at a reasonable distance** from the object or living being that you draw so that you can see the forms clearly.
3. Always **visualise the basic shapes** before you draw.
4. Draw the shapes **lightly** and quickly.
5. Draw multiple times on the same image **without using an eraser** so that you can see your mistakes, corrections, and improvements.
6. Observe the negative space and ensure that your sketch fits within your page.
7. Capture the basic structure, placement, proportions, and postures along with the actions.
8. Darken the lines and add details only when you are satisfied with the basic form and structure.
9. **Focus on the important parts** while adding details.



Note to the teacher: Refer to the activities in the textbooks *Bansuri* and *Kriti* that give details about drawing objects, people, and animals.

Activity 14.3

Daily sketching schedule

The table below can help you schedule regular sketching with weekly targets. Aim to spend more than the minimum time mentioned here.

Note: Sketch in your journal or on any paper which you can later paste into your journal. Write the date, time, and place.

Minimum time per sketch	Themes	Sketches per day
5 minutes	Objects in your school or home	2
10 minutes	Plants/landscapes in your school/home	2
10 minutes	Animals, insects, birds, and other life forms in your natural surroundings	1
10 minutes	Different actions/postures	2
15 minutes	Buildings and architectural details	1
Weekly target		8 sketches

Activity 14.4

Apply the principles of visual design

1. Revise the principles of visual design

The principles of visual design are important concepts that help us improve the aesthetic qualities of artworks. These principles guide the structure, arrangement, and overall composition of visual elements.

The six principles you will examine are:

- ◆ unity and harmony;
- ◆ balance;
- ◆ rhythm and movement;
- ◆ emphasis;
- ◆ proportion; and
- ◆ hierarchy (order of importance).

2. Observe and analyse the principles of design in printed material around you, including textbooks of other subjects.

3. Make three to four entries in your journal guided by these prompts:

- ❖ Look through old newspapers and magazines for interesting designs. You will find them in brand promotions, logos, advertisements, fashion photography, book cover designs, food wrappers, etc.
- ❖ You can also collect textile scraps and discarded food wrappers.
- ❖ Cut out designs that interest you and analyse the principles of design.
- ❖ Mention the principles that you observe in the design.
- ❖ You can also cut out examples that you think are not well-designed and analyse their problems.



Note to the teacher: Refer to the textbook *Kriti* Grade 8 Chapter 15 to revise the Elements of Art and Principles of Design, if students are not familiar with these concepts.

Continue journalling

As you keep journalling, try to observe details in your surroundings that you might have previously missed. Use the ideas given below to extend your journalling practice.

Journal your experiences of other art forms

- ❖ Study and draw the hand in different *hastas* practised in Dance.
- ❖ Study and draw facial expressions practised in Dance and Theatre.
- ❖ Study the postures and body positions of vocalists, instrumentalists, dancers, and actors.
- ❖ Study and draw musical instruments, jewellery, props, and objects used in various art forms.
- ❖ Find out which day of the week the newspapers in your region feature articles on art and culture. Gather pictures and articles about artists, performances, events, and places.
- ❖ Note down your observations and art experiences regularly.

Journal your observations with other curricular subjects

- ❖ Make sketches to visualise and illustrate scientific models and mathematical concepts.
- ❖ Create interesting mind-maps and infographics to capture a sequence of thoughts and processes or to document a sequence of events.

EXERCISES

Q1. Which of these is not an element of art.

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| i. Form | ii. Balance |
| iii. Point | iv. Texture |

Q2. Write any two forms of visual journaling.

i. -----

ii. -----

Q3. Observe the artwork below and answer the following:

- Identify any three elements of art.
- How is balance created?
- Write about two or more aspects that attract you towards the artwork.



Fig. 14.5. Jamini Roy (Padma Bhushan), Santhal dance, Tempera on paper, 70.5cm × 36.5cm

Q4. Reflect on your own sketching and journaling process and answer the following:

- ◆ What themes do you enjoy observing and sketching from your surroundings the most?
- ◆ Choose one page in the journal that you are most satisfied with. Give reasons for your choice in comparison with the other pages.
- ◆ What did you find difficult or challenging while sketching and journaling?